Lesson for the course “Human-Computer Interaction”

Notes on the exam

Prof. Luca Turchet

UNIVERSITY
OF TRENTO - Italy

Exam: the report

- The report must be maximum **12 pages long** (excluding the index and references), fontsize 11, margins 2.5 cm
- The report can be written in Italian or in English
- You can attach some appendices (e.g., the presentation about the benchmarking, the design library, all the personas and scenarios, etc.), **but in the 12-page report you need to have all the relevant information**, including the most important personas and related scenarios (if you don't use a video for scenarios of course)
- You are primarily judged on the report content, secondarily on all the complementary material you generate

Report: list the individual contribution

- **If each member feels to have had an equal contribution to the project, then you don't need to do anything**
- If someone has done much work than the others this should be stated in a 13th page. All group members need to agree on the statements. Each member needs to write down what has been his/her individual contribution
- If there is any issue between the group members (I really hope not) you should split the group and do the exam individually, but you must write in the 13th page what happened
  - Please make any effort to resolve group conflicts: conflict resolution is actually part of the project work….. and it is something that you might face in real life during your career

Report structure

1. Executive summary (max 1 page): a clear, concise description of what you did, including methodology and results achieved
   - Here is where you may add the **motivations** for the project
2. Analysis of existing products and ideas generation
   - Examples found during the benchmarking and critical analysis of why they are relevant for your work
   - Design space identified
3. PACT analysis
   - Data gathering technique/s (procedure, results, and derive the requirements list)
   - Rich description of requirements with implications for design

Report structure

4. 1st Iteration
   - Design methodology (personas, envisioning scenarios, etc.)
   - Prototyping (low-fidelity)
   - Evaluation

5. 2nd Iteration
   - Design (adjustments done on the basis of the previous evaluation)
   - Prototyping (medium-fidelity)
   - Evaluation

5. Conclusions
   - What are the lessons learned, strengths and limitations, and possible future extensions of the project (what remains to be done? What would you do if you had more time?)

Report structure

- A mix of text explanations and pictures (photos, drawings, screenshots)
- Remember to tell about the process and what motivate your design choices, not just the final solution
- So, document everything you do, possibly when you do it (pictures, decisions, etc.): you need to demonstrate that your claims are supported by data
- Be careful with the layout and grammar
- Remember the criteria of evaluation described in the syllabus (and also reported in the slides of Lesson 1)

Criteria for the assessment of the group project and report

- Coherence and quality of the application of the theoretical concepts presented during the module
- Complexity and quality of the interactive prototype and quality of the resulting interaction in relation to the target user group for which it has been designed
- Originality, creativity, and innovation of the proposed solution
- Conceptual quality of the content, including the level of the critical reflection in relation to the topics presented during the lessons, the clarity of the motivations explanation, and the relation to the theoretical aspects presented during the lessons
- Clarity of the text, in terms of content, layout (including figures, tables) and grammar

Some tips to write a good report

- The content of the report must be clear
  - Appropriate structure of sections and subsections
  - Good layout of figures/tables
  - Good optimization of the space (e.g., the amount of text/figures is appropriate for a certain section)
  - Text: should be essential but complete, i.e., it should contain all information needed to communicate your work
  - You can highlight in bold the most important words or sentences
  - You can consider placing links to the google drive material in the text so to facilitate my task of finding the resources (but double check that the links work…)

Some tips to write a good report

- **NOTE:** there is a page limit for a reason. You need to be able to describe your project activities in a clear way within the maximum space allowed
- So, do not rely too much on the online content, what is important is that everything relevant is in the report
- I mostly use the material on the google drive folder to check if you did what you say to have done, or to check material that can't be placed in the report (e.g., presentation of design library, all questions of a questionnaire, the raw results of quantitative analysis, etc.)

Some tips to write a good report

- You need to demonstrate to have learned and applied the methodologies seen during the course
- You need to demonstrate to have critically reflected about the data and results collected from the interactions you had with participants
- **You need to demonstrate that you actually did the things you say to have done in the report**
  - If you say to have done 15 interviews you need to provide the audio/video of them. You can attach the signed consent forms and the transcription of the interviews
  - If you say you did observations, then you can have pictures or write down notes with your annotations you made during the observations
  - The same for brainstorming (e.g., provide pictures affinity diagrams, notes, any other document about this activity)

Tips for a good video

- You need to demonstrate in 3-5 minutes how the prototype works
- You can start by explaining what the project is about
- **Show very well all the interactions you developed**
  - Show how the prototype is usable and delivers a great UX
- To explain the interactions consider using text, or a narrating voice
- You can use a background music track if you want (but be careful with the balance of music and voice volumes)
- **The goal is to communicate effectively the result of your project activities and to show how the prototype works**

Exam: checklist

- You need to send via e-mail to me (luca.turchet@unitn.it) the following:

1. **Report** (in PDF format) – in attachment
2. The Axure RP **file** – in attachment
3. **Link** to the project on **Axure RP cloud** (do not use passwords when sharing it with me)
4. **Link to the YouTube video** of your prototype in action
5. **Link to the Google Drive folder** (which must be well organized and appropriately named) containing
   - The video of your prototype in action
   - All material you created to accomplish the project (e.g., questionnaires, interviews results, audio/video recordings, etc.)

Exam: checklist

- **Make sure that by the deadline I have access to all material online**
  - Not only the main folder on Google Drive, but all the subfolders
  - The YouTube video of the medium fidelity prototype in action must be **public** (in this way you are sure I can have access to it; still you need to provide the video e.g., mp4, in the Google Drive folder)

- When you send the e-mail **put in cc all your team members**, but list their names and last names in the e-mail body (as well as on the PDF report)

- Don't expect that I confirm to have received the material: if you have sent the e-mail with all the content then you can safely assume that I have received it

Note

- **You automatically fail the exam if:**
  - You don't provide ALL the material requested (see checklist)
  - You exceed the number of pages
  - You do not demonstrate that you have conducted interviews or evaluations
  - You copy part of your project from other projects of previous years or from other institutions or from online material (**plagiarism**)

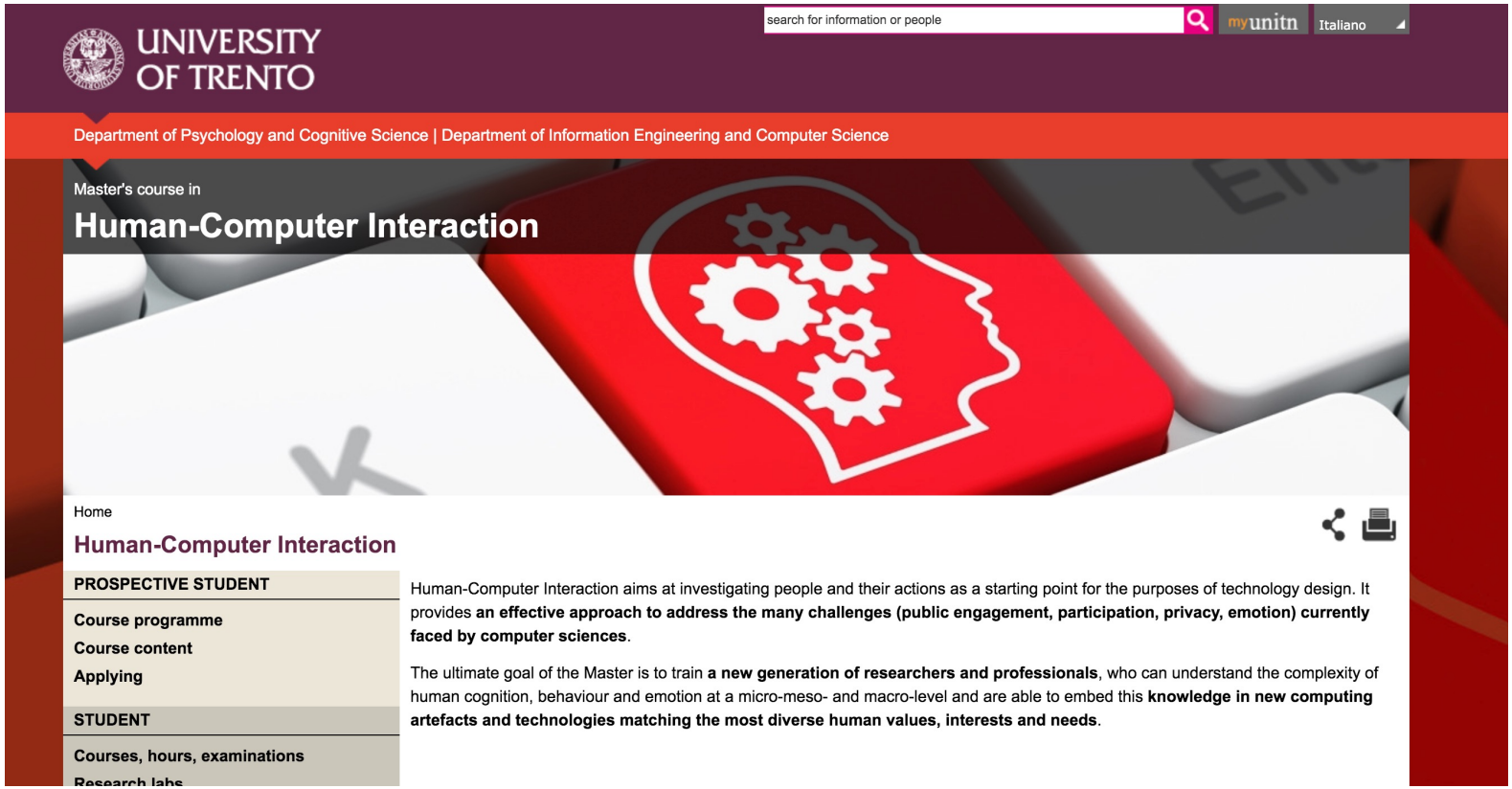
- **Note: please don't forget to register to the exam**

Note

- I am not going to provide any individual feedback about the project after the end of the course
- You can always contact me for clarifications about the content of the course, **not about your specific project**
- Before asking questions please remember that you have several sources where to find the information you need, including the **FAQ document**, all the **slides**, but also the book and the links in the slides

Master Degree in Human-Computer Interaction at UniTN

https://offertaformativa.unitn.it/en/lm/human-computer-interaction



Master Degree in Human-Computer Interaction and Design from the EIT Digital

https://masterschool.eitdigital.eu/programmes/hcid/

